Zaid A. Torres Salinas

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EDUCATION

Columbia University Mailman School of Public Health Expected May 2027
Master of Public Health, Population and Family Health | GPA: 3.94
- Certificate in Applied Biostatistics and Public Health Data Science

Texas A&M University May 2025
Bachelor of Science in Health, Allied Health; Minor in Nutrition | GPA: 3.96

Blinn College May 2022
Associate of Arts | GPA: 4.0

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Health Education Specialist (CHES®) | *National Commission for Health Education Credentialing*

Adult Mental Health First Aid | *National Council for Mental Wellbeing*

SKILLS

Technical: SAS (Intermediate), R (Intermediate), Stata, Qualtrics, REDCap, ASA24, NVivo

Research: Quantitative, Qualitative & Mixed-Methods Research, Statistical Analysis, Data Management, Survey Design, Qualitative Interviewing, Literature Reviews

Program & Communication: Program Coordination, Event Planning & Facilitation, Curriculum Development, Health Education, Community Outreach, Grant Writing, Scientific Writing, Presentation Development

Languages: Spanish (bilingual proficiency)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Columbia Mailman Department of Population and Family Health Aug. 2026 – Present
Academic Program Assistant
- Coordinate and promote departmental programming by developing promotional materials, distributing event communications, and leading certificate events for first-year students.
- Support faculty in improving course accessibility by implementing accommodations and accessible course materials for students with disabilities.

Catholic Charities Archdiocese of New York Jul. 2026 – Sep. 2026
Columbia FORWARD Fellow | Site Coordinator
- Coordinated classroom programming, guest speakers, field trips, and virtual and in-person sessions for a city-funded youth employment program.
- Designed and delivered a six-week health education curriculum for 36 adolescents ages 14–15, covering cultural humility, racism, implicit bias, nutrition, substance use, reproductive health, and related public health topics.

Section for Health Equity, Department of Population Health, NYU Langone Health May 2026 – Present
Research Intern
- Collected nutrition-related data through in-person, Spanish-language surveys with residents of the South Bronx, New York.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

2025 Medical Provider Survey Jul. 2025 – Present
Student Investigator
- Developed a national survey examining providers' perceptions of undocumented immigrants in the U.S.

Unseen Struggles of Undocumented Youth Jun. 2025 – Oct. 2025
Research Team Lead
- Secured a $1,275 grant to fund the project and led two undergraduate research assistants in presenting at the Healthy Futures of Texas state conference.

Bryan Healthcare Access for Immigrants Feb. 2025 – Present
Student Investigator
- Developed research protocols to ensure complete confidentiality of study participants.

- Recruited and interviewed participants, then transcribed and translated interviews.

Reproductive Justice Population Study May 2024 – Sep. 2024
Undergraduate Research Assistant
- Contributed to an NSF-funded population study on the effects of state laws and the Affordable Care Act on reproductive justice.
- Transcribed and coded interviews between primary researchers and lawyers/advocates of reproductive justice cases.

Jane's Due Process Emergency Contraception Kits Jan. 2024 – Apr. 2024
Undergraduate Research Assistant
- Reviewed, interpreted, and coded emergency contraception delivery data from Jane's Due Process.
- Developed and presented recommendations to expand service access for its target demographic at the organization's board meeting.

PUBLICATIONS AND PRESENTATIONS

(In progress) Blackburn Crudo, C., Franklin, K., Boyce, M. R., Rico, M., & Salinas, A. (2025). Characteristics associated with American attitudes toward inclusion of undocumented immigrants in disaster preparedness and response: A national survey.

Torres Salinas, Z., Sanchez, E., & Zafa Medrano, L. (2025, April). *The unseen struggles: Access to healthcare and opportunities for the undocumented*. Presented at the Healthy Futures of Texas Annual Symposium, Dallas, TX.

Williams, M., McNeill, B., Fehr, S., Rhonda, R., Dorsett, L., Rundell, R., Arnold, M., **Torres Salinas, Z.**, & Esquivel, C. (2024, May). *Prepare me as a health professional: Lessons learned from a college-level human sexuality course*. Presented at the Healthy Futures of Texas Annual Symposium, Austin, TX.

LEADERSHIP

Texas A&M NYC Club Dec. 2025 – Present
Vice President of Finance
- Develop the annual budget and maintain accurate financial records to preserve non-profit status.

University Health Services & Operations Task Force, Texas A&M University Sep. 2024 – Jun. 2025
Appointed Student Member
- Collaborated with university administrators and stakeholders as student representative in evaluating health services, facilities, and operations.
- Helped develop recommendations for construction, renovation, and expansion of health services facilities for presentation to the university president.

Committee for the Awareness of Mexican American Culture, Texas A&M University May 2024 – May 2025
Vice President of Programs
- Led a team of two to create culturally representative programs with a budget over $20,000 and combined attendance of more than 2,000.
- Drafted grant proposals that secured a total of $3,865.

Hispanic Presidents' Council, Texas A&M University May 2023 – May 2024
External Affairs Associate
- Managed the campaigns of two students who won seats in the Texas A&M Student Senate.
- Gathered support from university donors to secure a $10,000 donation.

COMMUNITY SERVICE

Emergency Contraception for All Aug. 2023 – Sep. 2025
- Delivered more than 200 emergency contraception pills to students in Bryan-College Station.

Hispanic Forum of Bryan/College Station Aug. 2022 – Aug. 2025
- Reviewed 25 scholarship applications for incoming college students and helped collect more than $1,000 in donations.

St. Joseph Regional Hospital Aug. 2021 – Jun. 2025
- Monitored patient vitals, attended to patient needs, and oversaw medical supply availability in patient rooms.

Red Cross Brazos County Vaccination Hub Feb. 2021 – Jan. 2022
- Served as lead translator for more than 250 community members during COVID-19 vaccine appointments.
- Advocated for expanded resources for Spanish-speaking communities, contributing to the creation of satellite clinics.